violent activism. The group's commitment to dawa had been extant since its inception, and once it began receiving state support Lashkar devoted significant resources to building additional mosques and madaris as well as to providing social welfare and educational services. Its growing reputation as a jihadi force fighting to liberate Indian-administered Kashmir also enhanced its standing among sections of the Pakistani populace, heightening its ability to raise money for missionary outreach and to recruit members from other sects, who were promptly converted upon joining.[27] Thus, while its sectarian orientation did not change, its approach did. In a sign of the group's maturity in this regard as well as of its growing stature in Pakistan, members of the federal and Punjabi governments reportedly solicited Lashkar's support against sectarian violence in 1998.[28]

Lashkar's leaders view missionary outreach as part of a larger reformist project to transform Pakistan. According to JuD spokesperson Abdullah Muntazir, 'Pakistan's foundation stone is La ilaha illa Allah [there is no God but The God] and so there is no difference between Pakistan and Islam.' However, the creation of Pakistan will be complete only when it becomes a truly Islamic country. Thus, the aim is to 'bring Muslims of Pakistan to the true meaning of Islam and to work not only for the purification of their beliefs, but also of their deeds.' This will enable the group to 'establish a society in Pakistan that is according to the true teachings of Islam.'[29] As Hafiz Saeed explained during an interview with Radio *Sada-e-Hurriyat*, 'We do not believe in revolutionary change in Pakistan rather we want a gradual reform through dawa.'[30]

The group's abstention from revolutionary jihad in favor of dawa is a function of doctrinal precepts and strategic priorities. In the Lashkar tract *Jihad in the Present Time*, Hafiz Abdul Salam bin Muhammad wrote that Pakistan's leaders 'do not at least outwardly and apparently disown Islam though they do follow a policy based on hypocrisy.' However, he argued there is a difference between a hypocrite and an avowed disbeliever, thus, the struggle in Pakistan 'is not a struggle between Islam and disbelief.'[31] Hafiz bin Muhammad elaborated on the importance of distinguishing between misguided Muslim rulers and non-Muslim aggressors in *Why We Do Jihad*, arguing that waging war against the former detracts from the ability to defeat the latter: